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A STORY OF KERALA

The Axe and the Brother

A tale of Parashurama-Kshetra



The Axe and the Brother

A tale of Parashurama-Kshetra

A tale of Parashurama, the old axe-bearer,
and the brother he could not stop loving.

From Hulmane — The Saga

Retold for young readers



Parashurama is the oldest hero of all. He has carried his great axe since he was a young man.



He lives in Kerala, a green land won from the sea, full of rivers, temples and elephants.



Long ago, he and his friend Maya trained under one wise guru. They were like brothers.



His axe, Parashu, was forged from a fallen star.
It was heavy enough to crack a wall.



But Maya wanted a forbidden power. He learned a secret form, and it changed him into Maya-Sura.



Now one man could become a thousand arms.
No one could tell which one was real.



Maya-Sura and his fighters attacked. Brave Theyyam warriors in bright paint rose to defend the land.



He struck the great temple during its festival.
Phantom fighters filled the frightened crowd.



Parashurama was hurt, for he loved his brother too much to strike hard. His old elephant Gajendra gave him comfort.



In a cave behind a waterfall waited a magic conch. It could show any enemy's weakness — to a brave heart.



Maya-Sura attacked again at the great boat race.
Thousands of joyful people were suddenly in
danger.



Parashurama blew the conch. Its deep sound showed the truth: all the copies grew from one real foot.



He swung at the one real foot. The thousand arms vanished like smoke. Only his brother was left.



Parashurama did not kill his brother. He saved him. For that, the elephant mark spread across his whole body.